OSPREYFLOW

Architecture Guide

OspreyFlow is an open source intelligence mapping platform for crime analysis, anti-money-laundering, fraud detection, and event monitoring and alerting, developed by Solirius Reply and released under the Apache License 2.0.

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Version	Date	What changed
1.0	2026-11-09	First issue: the two architecture levels, the tiers and ports, the four places, cases and datasets (one dataset per case, home cases, the analyst layer, views instead of branches), access control in the store, where the data lives, every interface, the licence register's traps, and the limits.

Contents

1. Level 0: who uses it, and what it touches 5
2. Three tiers, four ports 6
3. Level 1: every component 7
4. The four places 8
5. Cases and datasets 8
6. Access control in the store 9
7. Where the data lives during analysis 9
8. Every interface, and what crosses it 9
9. Open source, and the licence traps 10
10. What it deliberately does not do 11

List of figures

Figure 1 — Level 0: the people who use OspreyFlow, its three tiers joined by four ports, and the identity provider, reporting, data in and the optional outside services beside it 5

Figure 2 — Level 1: every component by tier with the technology it is built on, the ports between the Conduit and the Vault, identity, reporting, and what each mode runs on 7

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For architects, security reviewers and anyone deciding whether OspreyFlow fits their organisation: how it is built, what crosses each boundary, how access is enforced, how cases and datasets relate, and what it deliberately does not do. It describes what is built, and says plainly where something is not yet ("coming").

The other guides in this folder are the administration guide (administration-guide.pdf), for whoever installs and runs OspreyFlow, the user guide (user-guide.pdf), for analysts, and the developer guide (developer-guide.pdf), for data engineers.

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1. Level 0: who uses it, and what it touches

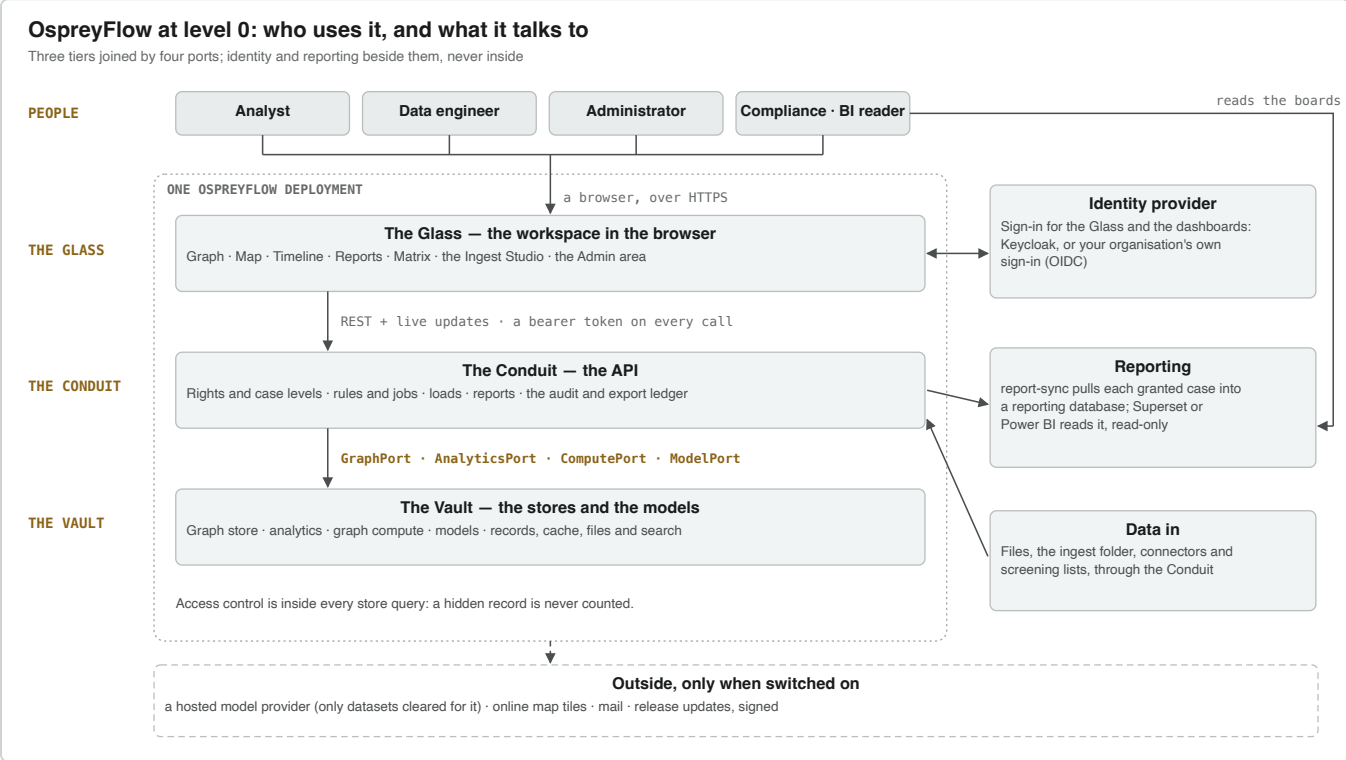


Figure 1. Level 0: the people who use OspreyFlow, its three tiers joined by four ports, and the identity provider, reporting, data in and the optional outside services beside it

OspreyFlow is one deployment for one organisation. The people who use it each hold one or more **roles** (the user guide's section 4 and the administration guide's section 9.2 say what each lets a person do):

Role	What they do in it
Analyst	Investigates cases, works alerts and keeps watches. Reads figures and boards.
Data Engineer	Builds and runs pipelines, reviews promotions into a dataset and decides held rows.
Administrator	Looks after people, roles, teams, datasets and the deployment. Does not investigate by being one.
Reports Viewer	Reads a case's figures and the dashboards, and sees the alerts on cases they can read. Never works an alert.

Role	What they do in it
Rule author	Writes the rules that raise alerts, and works the alerts in the queue.

Around the three tiers sit the **identity provider** (Keycloak, which says who someone is; it can hand sign-in to the organisation's own provider), **reporting** (a feed the Conduit serves, pulled into a reporting database that Superset or another BI tool reads), **data in** (files, a watched ingest folder and connectors to SQL databases, HTTP APIs and screening lists), and the **outside services** a deployment may switch on: a hosted model provider, mail, online map tiles, the organisation's sign-in, and the cloud's managed services.

2. Three tiers, four ports

Tier	What it is
The Glass	The browser workspace: one web application holding the four places (section 4)
The Conduit	The API (FastAPI), stateless and horizontally scaled. Every request is checked against the person making it, and access control is applied inside each query to the stores, never after
The Vault	The stores: the graph store (ArcadeDB), the analytics database (DuckDB inside the Conduit, or ClickHouse shared by several Conduits), search (OpenSearch, or PostgreSQL full-text), PostgreSQL, the object store, and the models

Everything that passes between the Conduit and the Vault crosses one of four typed **ports**. A port is a narrow interface (a Python `Protocol`) that everything above it may call and nothing else may. Each has a conformance suite, written before any adapter, and an adapter is supported only once it passes it. Swapping the engine behind a port, say a laptop's in-process DuckDB for a cluster's ClickHouse, means writing one adapter and changing one line of configuration.

Port	What passes through it
GraphPort	Typed traversal of the graph, with the person's clearance, handling codes and case datasets injected into it
AnalyticsPort	Events, trends and histograms, filtered the same way
ComputePort	Graph algorithms: centrality, communities, ownership chains, over what the reader can see
ModelPort	Extraction, vision, transcription and embedding, through the LiteLLM gateway

Two narrower ports sit beside them: the **media store**, for content files (an S3-protocol store, or Azure Blob), and the **recognition port**, for the fast named-entity pass (Stanza by default).

Gremlin never leaves the Vault. The Conduit builds the graph store's queries; the Glass never sees one and never sends one. That keeps a move to another graph query language an adapter change, and it is the security boundary: no analyst can write a traversal that steps around the access filter.

3. Level 1: every component

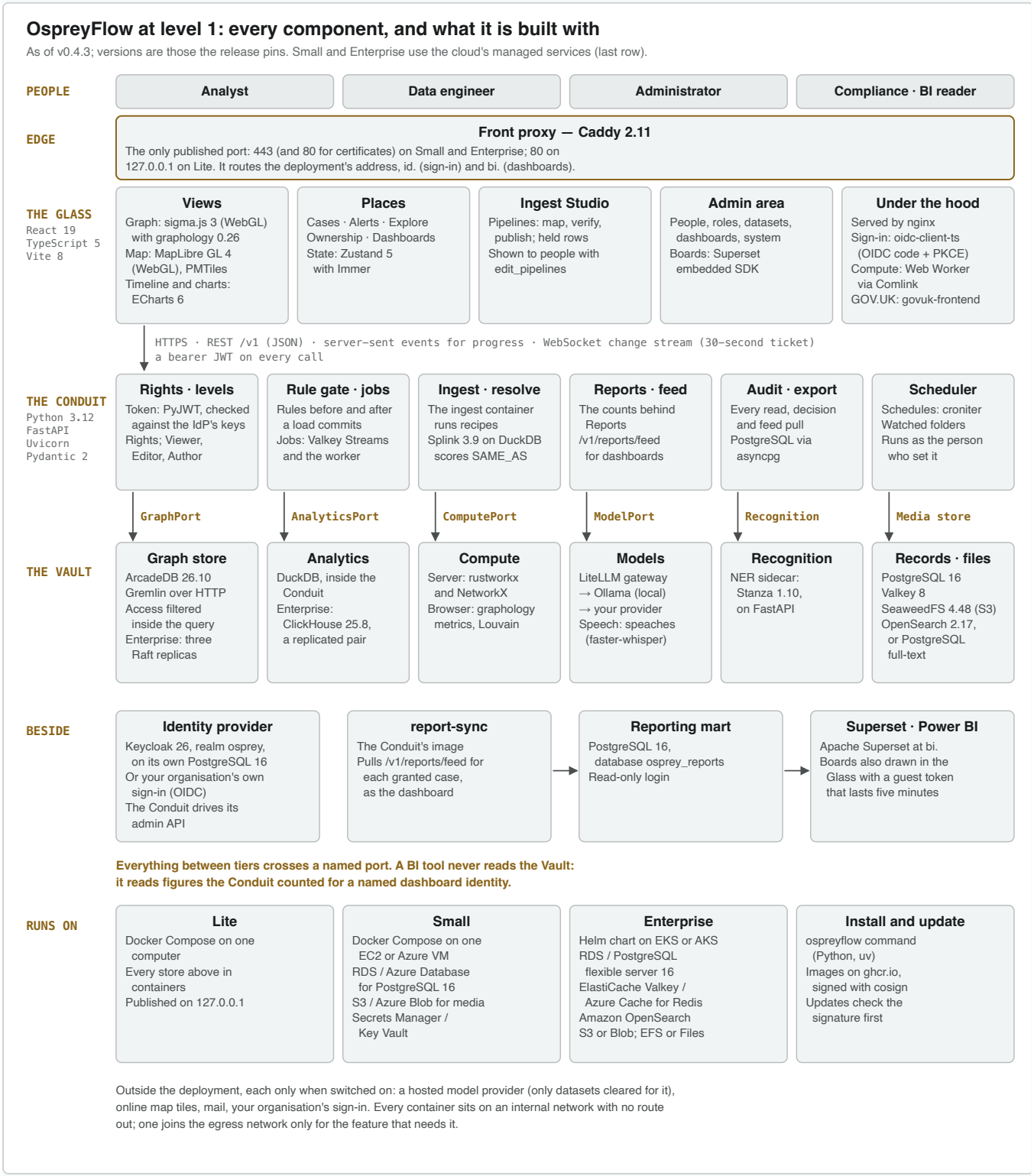


Figure 2. Level 1: every component by tier with the technology it is built on, the ports between the Conduit and the Vault, identity, reporting, and what each mode runs on

The level 1 diagram names the technology in each component; versions are those the release pins. Small and Enterprise use the cloud's managed services where the diagram's last row says.

One door in. A front proxy (Caddy) is the only published port: 80 on Lite (bound to the machine itself), 80 and 443 with HTTPS on Small and Enterprise. Behind it, at the deployment's address, are the Glass; sign-in at `id.`; and dashboards at `bi.`.

No route out by default. Every container sits on an internal network with no route to the internet. A container joins the egress network only when a configured feature needs it: the model downloads, the proxy's certificate, a client's own model provider, mail, an organisation's own sign-in, online map tiles, and on Small and Enterprise the cloud's managed services.

One set of images, three modes. Lite runs on one computer under Docker; Small runs on one server, in your cloud or your own network; Enterprise runs on Kubernetes (EKS or AKS). The same images and the same acceptance suite serve all three. The administration guide's section 1 compares them.

4. The four places

The Glass holds four **places**. A person sees only the places their roles open; a place hidden from them is one whose every route also refuses them, so hiding is never the control.

Place	For	Holds
The Glass	Investigate a case: search, expand, map, read its figures and its boards	Case · Boards
Ingest Studio	Bring data in: sources, pipelines, the domain model and held rows	1 Model · 2 Sources · 3 Pipelines · 4 Runs
Rules and Monitoring	Work the alerts that rules and watches raise, and see what raises them	Alerts · What raises alerts · Held rows · Changes
Admin	Run the deployment: people, roles, teams, datasets, models, maps and operations	Sections, each shown only to the holder of its right

A switcher in the top bar lists the places (keys G, I, R and A); under the GOV.UK theme the switch sits inside the GOV.UK header. **Coming:** releases between environments in the Ingest Studio, and the rule editor in Rules and Monitoring.

5. Cases and datasets

A dataset is a body of loaded data with one **domain model** (from a starter pack such as FIBO, NIEM or STIX, or bare people, objects, locations and events), its own unit and its own highest marking. Datasets are of three kinds: *Source* (loaded through the Ingest Studio), *Composite* (read from several sources, read-only for now) and *Drawn* (made by drawing, below).

A case is the only container an analyst works in. Each case reads **one dataset**, and every search, path, expansion, count and watch stays inside it. Each person holds a level on a case: Viewer, Editor or Author.

A home case per dataset. Every dataset has one home case, made when it is first made live and named for it. It holds the dataset's own reports and its dataset-wide alerts. A dataset's **Authors** are its home case's Authors: they answer for the dataset.

A case's analyst layer. What analysts write in a case (marking a record by hand, a link drawn by hand, a drawing board's items) goes into that case's own **analyst layer**, read together with the dataset and never written into it. No other case sees the layer, and none can infer it from a degree, a path length or a count. Accepted model proposals and extractions are written to the dataset as before.

Drawing boards. A board belongs to a case. On it an analyst declares a person, an account or a place and draws the links between them; each drawn item carries a marking, a grading in the deployment's scheme and a source. A drawing started with no case makes a **drawn dataset** of its own, with its home

case and a board. **Coming:** promoting drawn items into a dataset as a reviewed load, and merging a drawn dataset into another.

Views, never branches. A **case view** is a saved lens on a case: what was drawn, the filters and the period. Opening one reads the case through it, read-only. There are no branches and no copies of a case.

Records are never merged. Records that look like the same person are joined by a scored *same as* link and shown as one at the strictness the case is set to. Change the strictness and they come apart again.

What a model says is inferred. Anything a model produces stays *inferred*, drawn dashed, until a person confirms it. No confidence threshold promotes it on anyone's behalf.

6. Access control in the store

- **Every record carries its handling**: a classification, handling codes, an action code and a sanitisation code, set at load and checked again, item by item, at export.
- **The person travels with every read.** The Conduit resolves who is asking from the token and passes them into every read through the ports, counts included. The adapter puts the filter into the traversal or the `WHERE` clause. A record the reader may not see is absent, and so is any degree, path length, histogram bucket or figure that would reveal it. Each adapter's conformance suite holds it to that.
- **Seeing is not doing.** A case level and a right are checked before a route runs (a missing level answers as a missing case); neither widens what the reader may see.
- **The Glass never sees** a store's query language, a source system's identifier or an unfiltered count.
- **Nothing is cut silently.** A result over the working set's limit is refused with a typed `limit_exceeded` and three choices (save a smaller view, filter first, or run it as a batch job), never truncated.
- **Every read and write is audited**, with who, when and what; an expansion that crosses a handling boundary needs a justification.

7. Where the data lives during analysis

- **The persistent graph** is in the Vault and may be very large. Nobody queries it interactively.
- **The working set** is what one analyst is investigating: the subgraph they have expanded into and its events, bounded at 50,000 nodes and 250,000 links, held server-side in Valkey for the case and streamed to the browser as changes.
- **The browser set** is the working set in the browser's memory. The timeline brush, the map view and the filters work on it with no network call, which is why the views filter each other at once.
- **Kept out of the graph:** screening lists (their own store), held rows (a quarantine until a person releases or rejects them), and KYC status and risk, which are worked out at each read, as the reader, and never stored.

8. Every interface, and what crosses it

Each interface has one direction, one owner and one guard. The administration guide's *How OspreyFlow is built* gives the same table with each interface's transport.

Interface	From → to	What crosses	Guarded by
The front door	Browser → Caddy → the Glass, the Conduit (`/v1`), sign-in at `id.`, dashboards at `bi.`	Every request	The only published port
Sign-in and token	The Glass, Superset → identity provider → the Conduit	Credentials, typed only at the identity provider; then who the person is, their clearance, unit, handling codes and roles	Every token's signature checked on every call
Rights	The Conduit → the Glass (`GET /v1/me/rights`)	What this person may do; the places and menus follow it	Each route checks its own right
The API	The Glass → the Conduit (`/v1/…`)	Searches, working sets, edits, loads, figures, exports	Access control inside each store query; `limit_exceeded`, never a silent cut
Live updates	The Conduit → the Glass	Changes to the open case; progress	A one-time ticket, the person's own
Administration	Admin → the Conduit (`/v1/admin/…`) → the identity provider	People, roles, teams, datasets, models, maps, operations, audit	Each section's own right
GraphPort	The Conduit → ArcadeDB	Typed traversals; writes; a load's revert	The reader's clearance, handling codes and case dataset inside the traversal
AnalyticsPort	The Conduit → DuckDB or ClickHouse	Event aggregates, trends and histograms	The same filters inside the query
ComputePort	The Conduit → rustworkx and NetworkX; the Glass → graphology	Centrality, communities, ownership chains	Computed over what the reader can see
ModelPort	The Conduit → LiteLLM → the local models, or a provider you configure	Text, images and audio; what returns is *inferred*	Each dataset's egress and the handling codes that may be sent
Media store	The Conduit and the ingest container → the object store	Content files, staging, site images, the tile cache	Private storage; files reach the Glass only through the Conduit
Ingest	The Ingest Studio, the ingest folder and connectors → the Conduit → the ingest container	Files and rows, loaded under a deployed pipeline	The pipeline rights; a run is made as the person who set it
Reporting feed	report-sync → the Conduit (`/v1/reports/feed`) → PostgreSQL `osprey_reports` → Superset or a BI tool	Figures only, counted as that dashboard's account	The dashboard's own credentials; every pull in the export ledger
Updates	`ospreyflow update` → the repository's releases	The release list, its lock and its images	The release's signature, checked before anything changes

9. Open source, and the licence traps

The build fails if a dependency's licence is not on the allowlist (Apache-2.0, MIT, the BSD licences, ISC, MPL-2.0 and a short list of others). GPL and AGPL never pass; an LGPL package passes only with

a recorded exception, for dynamic linking alone. Several well-known components were avoided for their licence:

Avoided	Its licence	Used instead
Redis 7.4 and later	RSAL / SSPL	Valkey (BSD-3-Clause)
Elasticsearch	SSPL / Elastic Licence	OpenSearch (Apache-2.0)
Neo4j Community	GPL-3.0	ArcadeDB
ArangoDB	BSL 1.1	ArcadeDB
FalkorDB	SSPL	rustworkx for in-memory algorithms
Mapbox GL JS 2 and later	Proprietary	MapLibre GL JS (BSD-3-Clause)
MongoDB	SSPL	PostgreSQL, and an S3-protocol object store
Highcharts, AG Grid Enterprise	Commercial	Apache ECharts, TanStack Table
Grafana 9 and later	AGPL-3.0	Never bundled; acceptable only as an unmodified separate service
Stanford CoreNLP	GPL-3.0	Stanza (Apache-2.0), held at a version with no GPL dependency
Terraform	BSL 1.1	OpenTofu (MPL-2.0)

Data has licences too. A screening list's licence is recorded before its connector ships. Two are not confirmed for a customer's screening (the UN list; OpenSanctions, which is non-commercial only), so their connectors read OspreyFlow's own synthetic lists until they are. OspreyFlow ships only synthetic data: no real data is in the repository, its tests or its demonstrations, except a public dataset an administrator chooses to download and add on their own deployment.

10. What it deliberately does not do

- **No real-time streaming ingestion.** Loads are batches and small batches, on demand, on a schedule or from a watched folder.
- **No vector search in the graph store.** Embeddings are kept in search, so the graph store stays swappable.
- **No multi-tenancy.** One deployment serves one organisation. Handling markings and datasets partition what each person reads within it; neither is a tenancy boundary.
- **No mobile client.** The workspace is for a desktop analyst; it is usable at 1024 pixels wide for review.
- **Not yet assessed.** OspreyFlow is designed to meet the GDS Service Standard; an independent accessibility audit, a penetration test and a DPIA are planned, and only a service assessment panel can say a service meets the Standard.
- **Enterprise's in-cluster stores are not backed up by `ospreyflow backup` yet**: take snapshots of their volumes with the cloud's own tools (administration guide, section 13).